Signs and Symptoms

- Usually asymptomatic
- Head ache and dizziness, Blurred vision
- high BP
- Confusion
- Shortness of breath
- Nose bleeds
- Chest pain
- Irregular heart beat

Diagnosis

- BP measurements.
- ECG
- Chest X-ray
- BUN (Blood urea nitrogen) test and creatinine levels
- Proteinuria
- Urine (24-hours) for catecholamine's
- Renal scan to detect renal vascular diseases

Management

- Lose weight
- Avoid alcohol
- Regular aerobic exercise
- Lower sodium intake (2.4 gram or less per day)
- Stop smoking
- Reduce cholesterol and trans fat diet

Drug therapy

- Diuretics
- Beta-adrenergic blockers
- Alpha-receptor blockers
- Central alpha agonists
- Peripheral adrenergic agents
- Angiotensin converting enzyme (ACE) inhibitors

Nursing management

- Provide comfortable bed
- Measuring monitoring and charting BP.
- Advice low fat and low cholesterol diet
- Vital signs.
- Advice life style modification
- Regular follow up

Complications

- Myocardial infarction (MI)
- Heart failure
- Renal failure
- Stroke, hemorrhage
- Retinopathy

2.7 Stroke (Cerebrovascular Accident)

Stroke occurs when there is an ischemia (inadequate blood flow) to a part of the brain or hemorrhage into the brain that results in death of brain cells. Functions such as movement, sensation, or emotions that were controlled by the affected area of the brain are lost or impaired. The severity of the loss of function varies according to the location and extent of the brain involved. Following the onset of a stroke, immediate medical attention is crucial to reduce disability and death.

Definition

Stroke or Cardiovascular Accident (CVA) is the onset and persistence of neurologic dysfunction lasting longer than 24 hours and resulting from disruption of blood supply to the brain.

Types and Causes

Ischemic Stroke : About 80 percent of strokes are ischemic strokes. A stroke may be caused by a blocked artery (ischemic stroke)

- **Thrombotic stroke:** A thrombotic stroke occurs when a blood clot (thrombus) forms in one of the arteries that supply blood to brain. A clot may be caused by fatty deposits (plaque) that build up in arteries and cause

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